appeal to extend his detention.[80] Following Musharraf's January speech, the police detained thousands more militants and closed hundreds of offices.[81] According to the author's Pakistani interlocutors, within several months almost all of those caught up in the post-ban dragnet were allowed to seep back out onto the street.[82] The federal government failed to bring charges against those detained and even pushed the provincial authorities to release anyone who agreed to dissociate himself from militancy.[83] By the time the government began sealing militant groups' offices, these outfits had already moved their official operations to Pakistan-administered Kashmir at the direction of the army and ISI.[84]

This was a potential inflection point. Many militant outfits lost fighters in Afghanistan, where the US routed the Taliban more quickly than expected. Pakistan had become a key US ally against al-Qaeda and was beginning to reap the rewards of this alliance in the form of aid and debt relief. If ever there was a time to demobilize its proxies, this was it. Instead, the Musharraf regime chose to divide its so-called good jihadis from the bad. Pakistan would crack down on al-Qaeda and sectarian groups engaged in domestic terrorism, but maintain jihadi groups like Lashkar as assets for the country's regional strategy against India. Islamabad's double game had begun. However, Pakistan's proxies were not prepared to play by its rules.